

THE HIDDEN LAWS OF MONEY

The rules that quietly decide
who wins and who stays broke.



FREE SAMPLE

— ERIC COSTE —

FREE SAMPLE — INTRODUCTION & CHAPTER ONE

The Hidden Laws of Money

The Rules That Quietly Decide Who Wins and Who Stays Broke

ERIC COSTE

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Introduction

Nobody Taught You the Real Rules

Let me ask you something honest.

Have you ever done everything right? Worked hard, tried to save, maybe even read a few finance books, and still felt like you were running on a treadmill that someone else controls the speed on? Like no matter how fast you move, you never actually get ahead?

You're not imagining it. And you're not broken.

Here's what nobody told you: there is a second set of rules.

Not the ones you learned in school about budgeting and saving. Not the ones your parents passed down about working hard and being responsible. I mean a deeper layer, invisible, unspoken, rarely explained, that quietly sorts people into two categories: those who build wealth, and those who spend their lives wondering why they can't seem to hold onto it.

These rules don't care how smart you are. They don't care how good your intentions are, or how many hours you put in, or how much you genuinely deserve better. They operate in the background, like gravity. Whether you believe in them or not, they are working on you every single day.

The people who benefit most from these rules rarely talk about them. Not out of secrecy. Simply because the rules were installed so early, so quietly, that questioning them would feel like questioning gravity. They are not hiding anything from you. They are living inside

a framework they never had to consciously choose. And that framework, invisible to the people inside it, is exactly what this book is going to make visible to you.

That's what this book is about.

I wrote it because I'm tired of personal finance advice that treats money like a math problem. Like if you just cut your lattes and open a Roth IRA, your life will transform. That advice isn't wrong. It's just so incomplete it's almost cruel. It skips the part where your beliefs are quietly sabotaging your decisions. It ignores the part where your environment is setting your financial ceiling without your permission. It says nothing about how the wealthy actually build wealth: not through discipline alone, but through leverage, positioning, asymmetric risk, and systems that earn while they sleep.

This book doesn't skip those parts.

What you're holding is a map to the game that's already being played with your life as one of the pieces. Ten laws. Ten patterns that quietly decide who wins and who stays stuck. Some of them will make you angry, not at me, but at the time you've already lost. That's okay. Anger is useful fuel when it's pointed in the right direction.

You don't need to be born wealthy to win this game. You don't need connections, a prestigious degree, or a lucky break. But you do need to see the board clearly, all of it, not just the squares you've been told to play on.

And once you see it?

You cannot unsee it. The way you look at your job, your spending, your relationships, your habits, your opportunities: all of it shifts. That shift, that single moment of clarity, is worth more than any budgeting spreadsheet ever written.

So here's the question I want living rent-free in your mind from this page forward:

If the rules you've been following were designed by someone else, for someone else's benefit, what would you do differently if you finally learned your own?

Turn the page. Let's find out.

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Chapter 1: The Game No One Told You Was Being Played

You just read an introduction that asked you to question the rules you have been living by. This chapter is where we start identifying what those rules actually are, and who wrote them before you were old enough to have a say.

You Were Handed a Map to the Wrong City

Picture this. You wake up one day, look around at your life, and realize you've been following directions. You did the school thing. You got the job. You pay your bills, mostly on time. You're trying. You're genuinely, sincerely trying. And yet, something doesn't add up.

The numbers should work by now. You're not reckless. You're not lazy. So why does it feel like you're always one unexpected expense away from starting over?

Here's the uncomfortable truth nobody wants to say out loud: you were handed a map at birth, by your parents, your neighborhood, your school system, and your culture. And that map was drawn for a city most people never leave. A city called Survive.

The problem is, Wealth is in a different city entirely. And nobody gave you directions.

What if the life you've been carefully building was designed for someone else's destination?

The Rules Exist. You Just Were Never Told About Them.

Every system has rules. Sports have rules. Businesses have rules. Courts have rules. And money, the way it moves, accumulates, and multiplies in the real world, has rules too. But unlike a rule book you can open and read, the rules of money are passed down quietly, through behavior, exposure, and proximity.

A kid who grows up watching their parents negotiate, invest, and talk about ownership absorbs a completely different financial education than a kid who grows up watching their parents stretch a paycheck, avoid the phone on bill day, and treat credit cards like emergency oxygen.

Neither kid chose their classroom. But both kids got a lesson. And those lessons follow them into adulthood like a shadow they can't see.

The wealthy don't hoard their secrets out of malice. In most cases, they don't even know they have secrets. What looks like strategy to you looks like common sense to them. What feels like a breakthrough insight to you was just dinner table conversation to them at age twelve.

That gap, right there, is the real wealth gap. Not just dollars. Knowledge of the rules.

The most expensive education you'll ever receive is the one you didn't know you were getting.

The Two Players at the Table

Walk into any room and you'll find two types of people, though they rarely announce themselves.

The first type plays the game reactively. They respond to what life throws at them. They work when they need money. They save when they're scared. They spend when they feel good. Their financial life is a long series of reactions, and they're proud of how resilient they are, how well they handle the hits. Resilience is genuinely admirable. But resilience alone is not a wealth strategy. It's a survival strategy. And surviving is not the same as winning.

The second type plays the game proactively. They make decisions from a plan, not from emotion. They build before they need. They position themselves in front of opportunities instead of chasing them after they've passed. They think in systems, not in moments. They're not necessarily smarter or more talented. They're just playing a different game entirely.

Here's what's worth sitting with: most people don't choose which player they are. They inherit it. They absorb it. They become it without ever deciding to.

The moment you realize you've been playing by accident is the moment you can finally play on purpose.

The Creator Knows Something the Employee Forgot

There's a reason this chapter exists in a book and not in a classroom. Schools were not designed to produce owners. They were designed to produce employees: reliable, skilled, on time, and replaceable. That's not cynicism. That's history. The modern education system was built during the Industrial Revolution specifically to prepare people for factory work. The lesson plan hasn't changed as much as the machinery has.

The creator sees this clearly. The creator understands that showing up and doing good work is the floor, not the ceiling. That income tied to hours is a leash with a velvet handle. That the people writing the checks are not doing so out of generosity; they're doing so because your labor is worth more to them than what they pay you. That's not evil. That's just how the math works.

This isn't an argument against jobs or a romanticization of hustle culture. You can work a job and still think like a creator. You can be an employee Monday through Friday and be building something of your own on the side that follows a completely different set of rules. The archetype isn't about your title. It's about your posture toward money and opportunity.

Creators build. Employees maintain. Owners collect. The goal is to understand all three roles so clearly that you can choose which one you're playing at any given moment, instead of defaulting to the one you were handed.

If the system was designed without you in mind, the most radical thing you can do is design your own.

Seeing the Board for the First Time

Once you understand that a game is being played, you can't interact with money the same way again. The job posting looks different. The credit card offer looks different. The mortgage pitch, the subscription fee, the "limited time" deal, all of it starts to reveal its architecture. You start asking a new question, not "can I afford this?" but "what is this designed to make me do?"

That's not paranoia. That's literacy. Financial literacy isn't just knowing what a Roth IRA is. It's understanding whose interests every financial product, every system, every institution is actually serving. And then deciding, with full awareness, how you want to participate.

The people who win at this game don't win because they're lucky or gifted. They win because they learned to see the board. They learned the hidden laws. And then they built their lives around those laws instead of against them.

That's exactly what the next nine chapters are going to hand you. One law at a time. No jargon, no condescension. Just the rules of the real game, laid out clearly, finally, for the person who was never supposed to know them.

The board has always been there. You just needed someone to turn the lights on.

THAT'S THE FREE SAMPLE

Nine laws to go.

This book keeps going for nine more chapters: identity, proximity, velocity, asymmetry, leverage, perception, compounding, scarcity, and creation, each one a law that quietly decides who builds wealth and who stays stuck.

96 pages · 10 laws · 36-page workbook included

GET THE DIGITAL EDITION — \$26

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